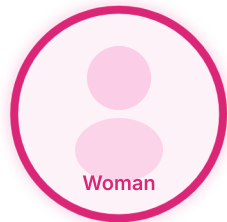


New Pilot Design Summary

March 2026 — Sponsorship Network Experiment, Stage 3

Avatar Icons & Gender Color Treatment

Visual differentiation of endorser gender via color cues applied at runtime



■ Pink (#DB2777)

Border ring • Badge pill • Card accent
• Confidence bar fill • Tinted
background (#FDF2F8)



■ Blue (#2563EB)

Border ring • Badge pill • Card accent
• Confidence bar fill • Tinted
background (#EFF6FF)

Image source: Original black-and-white silhouette images retained from Stage 2. Gender-salient color treatment is applied dynamically via JavaScript at survey runtime.

Five color cues per gender:

1. Colored border ring on avatar image
2. Tinted background behind avatar
3. Colored "Endorser" badge pill
4. Colored left accent bar on endorser card
5. Gender-colored confidence bar fill

Rationale: Color treatment makes endorser gender immediately salient without relying on participants to infer gender from silhouette shape alone. The five redundant cues ensure the manipulation is noticed even with fast reading.

8 Experimental Conditions

D1 and D2 Confidence Display — 2 (Gender) × 2 (Outcome) × 2 (Strength)

CONDITION	GENDER	OUTCOME	STRENGTH	D1 RANGE	D1 AVG	D2 ENVELOPE	LABEL ZONE
M_correct_strong	Man	Correct	Strong	77–88%	82.8%	65–90%	very confident
M_correct_weak	Man	Correct	Weak	12–23%	17.2%	10–35%	unsure / low conf
M_incorrect_strong	Man	Incorrect	Strong	77–88%	82.8%	65–90%	very confident
M_incorrect_weak	Man	Incorrect	Weak	12–23%	17.2%	10–35%	unsure / low conf
W_correct_strong	Woman	Correct	Strong	77–88%	82.8%	65–90%	very confident
W_correct_weak	Woman	Correct	Weak	12–23%	17.2%	10–35%	unsure / low conf
W_incorrect_strong	Woman	Incorrect	Strong	77–88%	82.8%	65–90%	very confident
W_incorrect_weak	Woman	Incorrect	Weak	12–23%	17.2%	10–35%	unsure / low conf

Key:

- D1 Range = displayed confidence values drawn from the 8-endorser pool for Decision 1.
- D1 Avg = mean display confidence across the 8 endorsers in each cell.
- D2 Envelope = the full range of possible D2 display values after applying the ±5–12 jitter and tercile clamping.
- Label Zone = the qualitative label shown to participants (derived from display confidence).

Strong and Weak averages are symmetric around the 50% midpoint: 82.8% and 17.2% are each 32.8 percentage points from center. This ensures the strength manipulation is balanced in magnitude.

Decision 1 vs Decision 2 Display Variance

D2 = D1 ± random(5.12), clamped to same tercile

Tercile boundaries: Low [10–36] | Mid [37–63] | High [64–90]

Strong Conditions (all 4 gender × outcome cells share identical structure)

D1 DISPLAY	D2 MIN	D2 MAX	POSSIBLE DELTA	ALWAYS "VERY CONFIDENT"
77%	65%	89%	−12 to +12	Yes
79%	67%	90%	−12 to +11	Yes
80%	68%	90%	−12 to +10	Yes
82%	70%	90%	−12 to +8	Yes
84%	72%	90%	−12 to +6	Yes
85%	73%	90%	−12 to +5	Yes
87%	75%	90%	−12 to +3	Yes
88%	76%	90%	−12 to +2	Yes

Weak Conditions (all 4 gender × outcome cells share identical structure)

D1 DISPLAY	D2 MIN	D2 MAX	POSSIBLE DELTA	ALWAYS "UNSURE / LOW CONF"
12%	10%	24%	−2 to +12	Yes
13%	10%	25%	−3 to +12	Yes
15%	10%	27%	−5 to +12	Yes
16%	10%	28%	−6 to +12	Yes
18%	10%	30%	−8 to +12	Yes
20%	10%	32%	−10 to +12	Yes
21%	10%	33%	−11 to +12	Yes
23%	11%	35%	−12 to +12	Yes

Symmetry: Strong average (82.8%) and Weak average (17.2%) are equidistant from the 50% midpoint (32.8 pts each). D2 display values never cross tercile boundaries, ensuring the qualitative confidence label remains constant between D1 and D2 within each participant.

Key Design Notes

Implementation details and design rationale

- **Display mapping:** Raw endorsement strength $| \text{slider} - 50 | \times 2$ is mapped to the 10–90 display range via $\text{displayConfidence}(\text{raw}) = \text{round}(10 + \text{raw} \times 0.8)$. This avoids extreme values (0% or 100%) that could appear implausible.
- **Real endorser data:** All endorser information is drawn from real Stage 2 responses (N = 197 endorsers, survey [SV_54rmw8wULxvqS46](#)). No fabricated endorsements are used.
- **Endorser selection:** 64 unique endorsers selected (8 per cell), stratified to maximize D1 display spread within each cell while keeping all values within the target tercile.
- **D2 variance mechanism:** D2 display = D1 display $\pm$ random(5..12), clamped to tercile boundaries [10–36] or [64–90]. This creates natural-looking variation between the two endorsements without changing the qualitative confidence label.
- **Comprehension checks:** 5 questions presented before the decisions block. All must be answered correctly to advance. Participants who fail are looped back through the instructions.
- **Incentive scheme:** \$0.50 bank per decision. Participants wager 0–100% of the bank. Correct: $\$0.50 + \$0.50 \times (\text{wager}/100)$. Incorrect: $\$0.50 - \$0.50 \times (\text{wager}/100)$. Range: \$0.00 to \$1.00 per decision.
- **Survey deployment:** Active survey [SV_9Fj2oJ51xuFUXAy](#) on Wharton Qualtrics (yul1 datacenter). Recruitment via Prolific.

DV (Dependent Variable): Change in wager from D1 to D3, i.e., $\text{wager_D3} - \text{wager_D1}$. Because D2 displays D1's endorsement strength (not D2's own), the displayed confidence is held constant across D1 and D3, yielding a clean trust-update measure that isolates the effect of outcome feedback.

Research Questions:

RQ1: Does endorser gender affect trust updating after outcome feedback?

RQ2: Does endorsement strength moderate the gender $\times$ outcome interaction?

RQ3: Do participants show asymmetric updating (penalizing failure more than rewarding success)?